Codependence — everything from the other account

Source: export of 826 chats; 41 mention codependence (Jun 2025 – Oct 2026). Quotes are your wording unless marked [Claude].

1. Your definitions, in order

- **Aug 9, 2025:** “The infantile dependence and hysterical demand for others to do for us to meet our existential needs, without whom and without which we’re sure we’ll die.” Clearest sign: “But we **must** have leaders! What would we do without leaders!”
- **Jul 13, 2025:** “The dynamic is easily identifiable and structurally simple: infantilism resulting in codependence.”
- **Nov 15, 2025:** Grown adults with “bifurcated psyches” — abjectly dependent on perceived greater-than-me “powers” for survival in some respects, self-enabling mature competence in others. Later revised: no real bifurcation — only one genuine consciousness, plus an overruling simulation.
- **Nov 16, 2025 (Working Definition, published):** “An artificial overlay we construct to override our own consciousness.” “It’s not consciousness at all. It’s a counterfeit—a performance we generate and maintain in order to avoid the terror of standing solely responsible for our part … with no authority to scapegoat.”
- **Nov 17, 2025 (In essence):** “The artificial overlay we use to overrule our own consciousness, simulating infantile dependency on external authorities for reality-assessment and sensemaking, because the alternative—solity … —triggers such profound terror that it feels like insanity or death itself.”
- **Oct 14, 2025 / Oct 3, 2026 (enablement test):** “Who do you depend on to enable you?” Codependence = can’t-unless-and-until; humanness = can-and-will-even-though. “So far, I have found no exceptions to this test.”
- **Oct 3, 2026 refinements:** not ability or capacity but the chosen source that enables them; a self-staged simulation, inauthentic by definition; product of trauma-induced suggestibility (“MKUltra principle”), so not an explicit choice in the moment — but leaving it takes an explicit conscious choice; triggered episodically like PTSD fugue states; the fully human count lapses into dependence as failure, codependents count dependence as the way to success; submission is codependent when it presumes the self is a failure without the higher power (a believer who embodies God’s power does not submit).
- **Final condensed test [Claude, Oct 3, 2026, after your corrections]:** “Codependence is a can’t-unless-and-until posture … you count that dependence as the way to success, not as failure … Humanness is a can-and-will-even-though posture. You enable yourself whether circumstances or others cooperate or oppose you … If you lapse or are coerced into dependence, you count it as failure.”

2. Framework components (Pt 1–3, Nov 2025)

- **Origin:** children are functionally codependent (appropriately); traumatic abuse by trusted authorities halts maturation in context-specific ways; church, state, market, education foster — and in places mandate — continued codependence. Survival by “dissociation, mimetism, and self-substitution” → fantasy personas → “the genesis of ego.”
- **Truth arbiter:** who gets to say what is, what matters, what it means, what to do. Only two options: me or someone else. Codependence erects authorities and their narratives as “definers, interpreters, and determiners of reality.”
- **Not epistemic at root:** codependence is pre-epistemic — “the platform from which the ‘how does one assess reality’ question is asked”; infantile epistemology is a symptom of an underlying, predominantly affective psychology.

- **Embodied wisdom:** “the imprint our experiences leave on the physical substrate of our person … our best-effort map and user guide to life.” Knowing (embodied) vs. knowing-about (narrative).
- **Two tethering operations:** (1) attaching consciousness to the embodied imprint — internal coherence (“Am I going crazy?”); (2) attaching that to the physical universe — reality-testing. Tethering ideas to ideas is not grounding.
- **Mechanism:** authority is wholly narrative; the competition is interpretive, not perceptual, but narratives are experienced and leave their own imprints, so they feed back into perception. Grooming (ritual, ceremony, obeisance, architecture, repetition) makes authority imprints win.
- **Nestling gape:** uncritical, begging openness to Freire’s “banking deposits,” informational and affective; it “invites and jubilates over substrate integration disruption.” A “groomed choice”; a deliberately cultivated pathology.
- **Solity:** standing alone as final judge on your own substrate-grounded consciousness; “the rock-bottom issue that scares the shit out of us.” Not isolation — others supply data you assess and integrate. An ontological fact, not a configuration of consciousness.
- **The terror (Nov 19):** real, but not triggered by solity itself — triggered by a hallucinated prospect of losing touch with reality, when the real loss is only the reality-grounding authority and its acolytes. Defense against nothing but acceptance of what is.
- **Mutuality:** “thoroughly but asymmetrically mutual” — authorities need self-subordinated subjects for their identity and “apparent realness”; “locked in mutual identity-fantasizing.” Real dyad: solity vs. existential others-dependence.
- **Compartmentalization:** people run on unimpaired consciousness where they feel competent and flip-flop into the simulation in high-import, existential-impact situations (medical, state, religious, expert, emergencies). This proves capacity, and the effort to maintain the overlay shows active commitment: it is both an unfortunate condition (the attack) and deliberate (the defense).
- **Psychosis:** “I cannot find non-psychotic elements in it.” Psychosis = experience severed from reality. Dec 20 tight definition [Claude]: “Experiencing representation as reality.” Aug 16: “Psychosis is both what drives us to jump into the shitpit of codependence as well as its price of admission.”
- **Narcissism:** an extreme form of codependence; driven by escaping accountability — not being in a position to be judged right or wrong; the narcissist seeks disappearance, not centrality.
- **Psychology’s position:** divers mapping a cesspool; existing psychology operates predominantly within codependence; ~95/5 adjustment vs. enrichment through the 1980s, ~85/15 now.

3. Observable markers you listed

- Panic at “What would we do without leaders?”; visceral terror at a credible prospect of no authorities/bosses.
- Treating dictionaries as authorities rather than records of usage.
- Instant attitude shift entering authority architecture (federal buildings, courts, sheriff’s office, churches).
- Ritual, ceremony, deference gestures: kissing rings, bowing, kneeling, “don’t sit in the presence,” rosary counting.
- Unknown = dangerous/evil; authority-free world felt with “visceral certainty” to be dangerous and evil despite total ignorance of one.
- Invoking narrative overlay (belief) only when operative confidence drops — the switch out of humanness into codependence (Dec 6).

4. The counterpart — terms tried

- “Humanness” / “feral humanness” / “fully mature adult humanness”; Maslow’s self-actualization re-termed.
- Humanness list (Aug 15, 2025, final): grounded, purposeful, self-motivated, competent, confident, fully embodied, deeply integrated, unyieldingly honest, amply aware, wondering, exploring, discerning, engaged, creative, vulnerable, playful, spirited, empathetic. “Moral courage” rejected — courage belongs to the codependent paradigm (overcoming fear the fully human don’t have).
- Pairs: solity ↔ heteronomy (orientation); autogenic ↔ exogenic (process); self-generative; self-grounded (closest, not 100%); “primary” consciousness vs. derivative simulation; counterpart is non-referential, since codependence is “flatly a derivation proposition.”
- Nov 22: faith in Jesus’s non-religious sense — no remaining honest question (brakes, Abraham in Rom 4:19-21 contemplating, not denying); religious “faith” is imaginative denial. Provisional: Simulation vs. Honesty; Manipulation vs. Faith; Denial vs. Faith. One true sin: dishonesty. The strait gate = choosing complete honesty; the “broad way” = the illusions of codependence.
- Retained “codependence” for its popular recognition (Al-Anon / 1980s recovery movement) while addressing its weaknesses; mutual dependence of authority and subject justifies the “co-”.

5. Applications

- **Cults (“Cultist, Actually,” Substack, Nov 2025):** “CODEPENDENCE: Seedbed of cultism.” “If you take the cultist out of the cult, the cultism remains in the cultist.” Codependence is “the sole critical, constitutive element for authoritarian groups … where the codependent carcasses are, there the vultures … will gather.” Exit often needs banishment to crack the simulation deeply enough.
- **Government/authority:** codependence belongs solely to supremacism/authoritarianism; humanness to partnership and peerness (Jul 23, 2025). Existential double-bind as standard authority MO (Jun 3, 2025).
- **Rights:** belong to an infantilistic paradigm of codependence — “a paradigm of psychosis” (Aug 14–16, 2025).
- **Belief:** “the default and rarely-departed-from mainstay of the codependent”; believing is repugnant to those who escaped it. Humility is just baseline honesty; difficulty is only for the arrogant/codependent/dishonest (Aug 9, 2025).
- **Religion:** results placed behind practices that humiliate or subordinate the faithful into codependence (Dec 7, 2025). Joseph Campbell’s raw data was codependent human culture (Dec 13). Le Guin queried (Dec 10).
- **Change approach (Dec 5, 2025, Fresco):** move to solity is like being born again — feels like insanity or death. Your method: call out the motivated, lied-about ignorance; “I don’t have to convince them of what’s true … tell them to stop fucking lying to themselves.” Earth doesn’t lie — that’s your ally.
- **Prevalence (Dec 14, 2025) [Claude]:** full solity across all domains estimated “low single digits at most, possibly less than 1%.”

6. Chat index

- Jun 2–3, 2025 — Diagram Conceptual Analysis; The myth of certainty
- Jul 13 / Jul 23, 2025 — Origins of Social Organization; Government’s Core Operating Principle
- Aug 9–16, 2025 — Epistemic narcissism; Violation; Minimalist Communication; Components of Authentic Humanness; **Humanness vs codependence**; Rights critique; UN Rights Declaration
- Sep 20, 2025 — Dogmas and identity traps
- Oct 14, 2025 — **Codependence versus humanness**

- Nov 15–19, 2025 — **Pt 1–3 Codependence as a psychological diagnosis** (core; 530 messages)
- Nov 22, 2025 — The narrow way and strait gate (faith/honesty counterpart)
- Nov 26 – Dec 31, 2025 — ownership; embodied wisdom; belief (2 chats); Fresco/change-by-attack; domination; religion; sacred violence; epistemic work (3); Le Guin; truth-seeking; Campbell; **prevalence**; **codependence and psychosis**; manuscript analysis/review Pt 1–2; Paul's "Lord"
- Oct 3, 2026 — **Codependence versus humanness: the enablement test**
- Oct 18, 2026 — Codependence as the foundation of cultism (looking for the article chat)